

DETACHMENT — HORUS HERESY (30K) PERFECT COUNTER

EMPEROR'S CHILDREN (HH, TRAITOR) | WARHAMMER 40,000 |
11TH EDITION

Perfect Counter is a fully homebrew Detachment for the Emperor's Children (III Legion) faction — a Horus Heresy-era Traitor Legion detachment adapted to the Warhammer 40,000 11th-edition Detachment framework, built from the real HH3e Emperor's Children Rite of War data. Formatted to match the No Figure Left Behind Combat Patrol archive.

FACTION ABILITY

FLAWLESS EXECUTION

A charge is only as good as the strike that ends it, and no Legion in the galaxy lands that strike more cleanly. Each time a friendly Emperor's Children unit that made a Charge move this turn is chosen to fight, that unit has the [FIGHTS FIRST] ability (this does not stack with Core).

DETACHMENT RULE

PERFECT COUNTER

Detachment Points: To use this detachment you must spend 1 DP.

There is no clumsier compliment than a charge that fails to kill you. Once per battle, each time an enemy unit declares a charge that targets a friendly Emperor's Children unit, you can select that Emperor's Children unit to immediately make a Charge move against the charging unit, as if it were your Charge phase (this does not use up your unit's normal Charge move this turn, and the enemy unit's Charge move still proceeds as normal afterwards).

FORCE DISPOSITIONS

This detachment has access to the following Force Disposition: Onslaught.

DETACHMENT COMPOSITION

Included: All homebrew Emperor's Children (HH) roster units (Fulgrim, Fulgrim Transfigured, Captain Lucius, Lord Commander Eidolon, Saul Tarvitz, Rylanor the Unyielding, Kakophoni Squad, Palatine Blade Squad, Palatine Blade Aquilae Squad, Phoenix Terminator Squad, Sun Killer Squad, Inductii Squad), and any homebrew Legiones Astartes (HH) unit from the generic Space Marines (HH) roster given the Emperor's Children Trait.

Excluded: Any other Legion's Primarch or named characters. Non-Legiones-Astartes allies, per standard HH3e Legion-purity convention.

ENHANCEMENTS

DUELLIST SUPREME — *Character model only*

Each time the bearer makes a melee attack that targets a Character unit, add 1 to the Wound roll.

MIRROR-POLISHED PLATE — *Character model only*

The bearer has a 4+ invulnerable save. If the bearer already has an invulnerable save, add 1 to its Invulnerable Save characteristic instead (to a maximum of a 3+ invulnerable save).

RELIC OF CHEMOS — *Character model only*

Melee weapons equipped by the bearer have the [DEVASTATING WOUNDS] ability.

STANDARD OF PERFECTION — *Character model only*

While the bearer is on the battlefield, each time a friendly Emperor's Children unit within 6" of the bearer takes a Battle-shock test, roll two dice and discard the lowest.

STRATAGEMS

PARAGON OF EXCELLENCE **1CP**

Emperor's Children — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Fight phase, when a friendly Emperor's Children Character unit is chosen to fight.

Target: That unit.

Effect: Until the end of the phase, that unit's melee weapons have the [LETHAL HITS] ability.

NOTHING LESS THAN PERFECT 1CP

Emperor's Children — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Command phase.

Target: One friendly Emperor's Children unit.

Effect: Until your next Command phase, each time a model in that unit makes an attack, you can re-roll the Hit roll, but if you do, you must also re-roll a successful Hit roll for that attack.

RAPTURE OF THE KILL 1CP

Emperor's Children — Epic Deed Stratagem

When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Emperor's Children Character model is destroyed, before it is removed from play.

Target: That model.

Effect: If that model has not already fought this phase, it can fight once, using its normal characteristics, before being removed as a casualty.

ADORING AUDIENCE 1CP

Emperor's Children — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Fight phase, just after a friendly Emperor's Children unit destroys the last model in an enemy unit.

Target: One other friendly Emperor's Children unit within 6" of that Fight.

Effect: Until the end of the turn, that unit's Leadership characteristic cannot be modified to be worse than 6+.

NO SUBSTITUTE FOR VICTORY 2CP

Emperor's Children — Strategic Ploy Stratagem

When: Your Charge phase.

Target: One friendly Emperor's Children unit.

Effect: That unit can declare a charge even if it Advanced or Fell Back this turn.

EXQUISITE CRUELTY 2CP

Emperor's Children — Battle Tactic Stratagem

When: Fight phase, when a friendly Emperor's Children unit is chosen to fight.

Target: That unit.

Effect: Until the end of the phase, that unit's melee weapons have the [PRECISION] ability.

DESIGNER'S NOTE

Homebrew — HH3e (2026) Emperor's Children Legion Rite of War → 11e conversion. Built from the real HH3e Rite of War data in `Emperor's Children.json`, which is unusually structured compared to every other Legion checked so far in this project: it has two full Rite of War variants rather than one — a baseline "Legiones Astartes Emperor's Children" rite and an Allegiance-locked "Legiones Hereticus Emperor's Children" variant (only selectable for a Traitor army, built around the real "Stupefied" tactical status — the first genuinely dedicated corrupted-Legion rite structure found in this project's HH3e data, foreshadowing the Legion's canonical descent into Slaanesh's excess). This detachment uses the baseline rite, since its own real mechanics (a duel-focused Initiative bonus, a Challenge-focus bonus, and a counter-charge Reaction) line up far more directly with this Legion's own roster identity — nearly every named character and squad built this phase carries some form of the real Duellist's Edge rule. Legion Tactical "Flawless Execution" (real: +1 Initiative on a successful Charge) is the Faction Ability, translated as granting Fights First to a unit that charged this turn. Gambit "Paragon of Excellence" (real: a Challenge-only +2 Focus Roll bonus, the same Gambit doubled by Captain Lucius's own real The Faultless Blade rule) became the Paragon of Excellence Stratagem, granting Lethal Hits. Advanced Reaction "Perfect Counter" (real: a once-per-battle counter-charge against a Unit that charged you) was promoted to the Detachment Rule itself, matching how every other Legion's flagship real mechanic has anchored its own detachment — and a fitting flagship for a Legion whose entire identity is refusing to be caught off-guard by an inferior swordsman. Nothing Less Than Perfect, Rapture of the Kill, Adoring Audience, No Substitute for Victory, and Exquisite Cruelty are original stratagems filling out the standard six (Rapture of the Kill mirrors the "fight from beyond death" Epic Deed pattern already established for other Legions); Enhancements are original, themed around the Legion's duelling and perfectionist-vanity identity.